INTRODUCTION
Hand Drum making workshop

In this workshop, we reconnect with the sacred drum. Drumming connects you with your bones, your heartbeat, and your natural rhythms. You connect with the drum by holding it close to your heart and letting your feelings transfer into the drum. When we breathe, we all beat upon a common drum. The drum acts as a mediator between the drummer and the spirits, between space and time, power and people. The drum can change the direction of a ceremony, calling everyone's attention and eliminating distractions. When we drum, our antennae are out and our intuition is acute; and we feel for atmosphere, feel for Spirit, as we wait and call for the sacred space to be filled with *waken* (all that is holy and sacred). The drum acts as a channel, a method of centering and projecting the attention into areas of consciousness that in normal life are unobtainable.

Drumming is an opportunity to serve Spirit, the very source of all of our lives and all that surrounds us on this beautiful planet. We need to feel inspiration, We need to feel as if we are coming from the real me, where love rests and there is no fear. We sit here, beating our drum, waiting for guidance, actively seeking guidance, through the slow, gentle connection that the drumbeat gives us. It does not take long; it is the intention that counts. As we strike the skin with the stick, we move into the desire to serve clearly, and in our minds, we begin to speak to Spirit.

FOREWORD
By Grandfather Wallace Black Elk

This is the story of the drum. The drum keeper is an old woman; she lives north at a lake far away. First came the thunder and lightning; this was the first wave. The second wave came, and the second wave was a continuous noise, continuous sound. The people who had come to seek the old woman asked each other, "Can you drum?" "No" was the answer from everyone. So there was no drummer.

They went on to meet the old lady, and when they got there at daybreak they heard the sound of the drum. It was a good sound, a sound of welcome for the Spirit-kin, for family; they could hear all their relatives in that drum sound. For four days they heard that drum beat and then found that it was a woodpecker tapping on a hollow log. So it is woodpecker who is the drum keeper.

This is a story of how the first ceremonial drum was made. They found a hollow log and they stretched an animal skin on each end, they put willow around it, and then they heard the rain, snow, wind, and all the natural elements. Then they heard thunder echo in the clouds with lightning flashing across the sky and they heard a voice yell; it was a woman's voice.